



Required Identity Verification Toolkit

Doc 6 - DRAFT

Staff Talking Points

These talking points are intended for college staff who answer student questions by phone, email, chat, in person, or through local support channels. The goal is to help staff provide clear, consistent, and student-centered information while ensuring local verification processes are followed appropriately.

Core Message for Staff

Identity verification is required before a student's information can be sent to the college. Most students will verify online through DMV Mobile Wallet or ID.me. Some students, including students under age 18, dual enrollment students, students in special admission pathways, and students who cannot complete online verification, may follow a different approved verification pathway.

If a student cannot complete online verification, staff should not bypass the requirement. Staff should direct the student to the college's approved local verification process.

Key Messages to Repeat Consistently

Identity verification is required

"Identity verification is now a required step in the California Community Colleges enrollment process. Your information cannot be sent to the college until your identity has been verified or you have been cleared through an approved alternate process."

Verification protects students

"This process helps confirm that your information belongs to you. It protects your student record and helps reduce identity misuse and fraudulent activity."

There are multiple ways to verify

"Most students verify online using DMV Mobile Wallet or ID.me. Some students may use another approved process, including local college verification, depending on their circumstances."

Verify Later does not skip the requirement

"Choosing Verify Later only changes when you complete verification. Your information still cannot be sent to the college until verification is complete."

Help is available

"If online verification does not work for you, the college can help you understand your next steps through an approved alternate verification process."



When a Student Asks Why Verification Is Required

Suggested response:

“Identity verification is required to help confirm that your information belongs to you. This helps protect students from identity misuse, reduces fraudulent activity, and supports a more secure admissions process. Your information cannot be sent to the college until your identity is verified or you are cleared through an approved alternate process.”

When a Student Asks What Changed

Suggested response:

“Previously, identity verification was available as an optional step for many students. Beginning August 11, 2026, it is required before your information can be sent to a college. This is part of a systemwide effort to protect students, strengthen admissions and financial aid processes, and reduce fraud.”

When a Student Asks How to Verify

Suggested response:

“Most students will verify online using DMV Mobile Wallet or ID.me. The form you use to get started will guide you through the available options. If you cannot complete online verification, contact the college so we can help you understand the approved alternate verification process.”

When a Student Asks About DMV Mobile Wallet

Suggested response:

“DMV Mobile Wallet allows eligible students to verify their identity using a California Mobile Driver’s License or mobile identification card. If that option is available to you, follow the prompts in the process. If DMV Mobile Wallet does not work for you, you may be able to use ID.me or another approved verification pathway.”

When a Student Asks About ID.me

Suggested response:

“ID.me is another approved online identity verification option. You may use ID.me if DMV Mobile Wallet is not available to you, if you do not have a California Mobile Driver’s License or mobile identification card, or if the process directs you to use [ID.me](https://www.id.me).”

Staff note: ID.me has updated parts of its verification experience to make the process faster, clearer, and easier for students to complete. Students may see a simplified document upload process, real-time feedback when submitting an ID image, and clearer consent language during the video selfie step. For step-by-step ID.me support, direct students to current ID.me help resources rather than older screenshots or local printed guides.



When a Student Says They Chose Verify Later

Suggested response:

“Choosing Verify Later allows you to finish **the form** first, but it does not remove the requirement. **Your information cannot be sent to the college** until you complete identity verification or are cleared through an approved alternate process. We recommend completing verification as soon as possible to avoid delays.”

When a Student Says They Cannot Complete Online Verification

Suggested response:

“If you cannot complete online verification, you may still have another approved pathway available. The college can help you understand your next steps through the approved local verification process. Identity verification is still required, but there is more than one way to complete it.”

Staff note: If the student is having difficulty with ID.me, encourage them to review current ID.me help resources before moving to local verification, when appropriate. ID.me updates its guidance as the verification experience changes, so current help articles may resolve issues caused by outdated screenshots or older instructions.

When a Student Does Not Have a Smartphone or Required Technology

Suggested response:

“If you do not have access to the required technology, contact the college for support. The college can help determine whether local verification or another approved verification pathway applies to your situation.”

When a Student Does Not Have a California Driver's License or Mobile ID

Suggested response:

“If you do not have a California Mobile Driver's License or mobile identification card, you may be able to verify through ID.me. If ID.me does not work for you, the college can help you understand whether another approved verification pathway is available.”

When a Student Is Under Age 18

Suggested response:

“Students under age 18 may follow a different verification pathway. Some students under 18 may be verified through trusted data sharing or a special admission process. If additional verification is needed, you may be asked to complete a parent or guardian-supported process,



an approved under-18 verification option, or local college verification. Please follow the instructions provided in your application, email, text message, or by the college.”

When a Parent or Guardian Calls About a Student Under 18

Suggested response:

“Students under age 18 may have a different verification process. Depending on the situation, parent or guardian participation may be required. We will follow the college’s approved process and provide the appropriate next steps. To protect the student’s information, we may need to confirm what information we can discuss and what actions are required from the student or parent or guardian.”

When a Dual Enrollment Student Needs Help

Suggested response:

“Some dual enrollment students may be verified through trusted data sharing or a special admission pathway. If additional verification is needed, the student should follow the instructions provided by the college, high school, the system they used to get started, email, or text message. We can help connect you with the right office for next steps.”

When a Student Asks Whether Verification Affects Admission

Suggested response:

“No. Identity verification confirms that your information belongs to you. It does not make the admission decision. Admission decisions are made by each college according to its admissions policies and requirements.”

When a Student Asks About Citizenship or Immigration Status

Suggested response:

“Identity verification confirms identity only. The California Community Colleges do not collect or store citizenship or immigration status through this verification process.”

When a Student Asks If Their DMV Photo Is Shared

Suggested response:

“No. The student’s DMV photo is not shared with the college through DMV Mobile Wallet verification. Colleges receive verification status and source information, such as whether the student was verified through DMV Mobile Wallet, ID.me, or an approved local process.”

When a Student Asks How Long Verification Lasts

Suggested response:



“Identity verification is generally valid for 12 months unless your information changes or re-verification is required. You may be asked to verify again if your verification expires or if you change key identity information in your OpenCCC account.”

When a Student Applies to More Than One College

Suggested response:

“In most cases, identity verification is connected to your OpenCCC account and may apply across multiple California Community College applications during the valid verification period. You may need to verify again if your verification expires or key information changes.”

When a Student Says Their Application Was Not Sent

Suggested response:

“Your information cannot be sent to the college until identity verification is complete or you are cleared through an approved alternate process. Please complete the verification steps provided in your form, or contact the college if you need help with an alternate verification pathway.”

When a Student Is Frustrated

Suggested response:

“I understand this may feel frustrating. Identity verification is now required, but there are multiple ways to complete it. Our goal is to help you move forward while protecting your information and student record. Let’s look at which verification pathway applies to your situation.”

When a Student Asks Staff to Verify Them Over the Phone

Suggested response:

“For your protection, we cannot complete identity verification based only on a phone conversation. We need to follow the college’s approved process to confirm we are working with the correct student. I can help you understand the next step in that process.”

When a Student Provides an Emotional or Urgent Explanation

Suggested response:

“I understand this is important and time-sensitive. Identity verification is required before your information can move forward. We need to follow the approved process to protect your student record and confirm we are working with the correct student. Let me connect you with the appropriate next step.”



When Staff Suspect Fraud

Suggested response to student:

“We are unable to complete verification until the required review process is complete. This protects student records and helps ensure we are working with the correct person.”

Internal staff action:

Follow local escalation and fraud reporting procedures. Do not complete local verification if the identity of the authentic student cannot be confirmed through the approved process.

Staff Guidance: Verifying the Authentic Student

College staff may hear from individuals who are unable or unwilling to complete online verification and request help bypassing the process.

Some requests will be from legitimate students who need assistance. Others may be attempts to bypass verification.

Staff should follow approved local procedures before updating a verification status, advancing a student's next steps, providing account assistance, or taking any action related to admissions, enrollment, or financial aid.

Before completing local verification, staff should confirm:

- The college's approved verification process is being followed.
- The person requesting assistance is the authentic student.
- Documentation or identity evidence meets local requirements.
- Parent or guardian involvement is addressed when required.
- The case does not require escalation.
- Student privacy is protected.
- The outcome is documented according to local procedures.

If staff cannot confirm they are working with the authentic student, they should pause and escalate according to local procedures.

What Staff Should Not Say

Avoid saying:

- “Verification is optional.”
- “You can skip verification.”
- “I can clear this for you over the phone.”
- “Just send me a picture of your ID.”
- “This will not affect anything.”
- “You do not need to worry about verifying.”
- “The college can override it for you.”

Use instead:

- “Identity verification is required before your information can be sent.”
- “There are multiple approved verification pathways.”
- “If online verification does not work, the college can guide you through an approved alternate process.”



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- “For your protection, we need to follow the approved process to confirm we are working with the correct student.”

What Staff Should Not Do

Staff should not:

- Bypass identity verification based only on a phone call, email, or verbal explanation.
- Complete local verification without following approved procedures.
- Use Staff Verified status as a convenience measure.
- Request or retain unnecessary sensitive documents.
- Send or receive sensitive identity documents through unsecured channels unless allowed by local policy.
- Promise immediate admission, enrollment, financial aid, or account access before verification is complete.
- Ignore suspicious patterns, inconsistent information, or fraud indicators.
- Provide access to an account or student record if the student’s identity has not been confirmed.
- Move a student to local verification only because an older ID.me guide or screenshot no longer matches the current ID.me experience. First direct the student to current ID.me help resources, when appropriate.

When to Refer or Escalate

Refer or escalate when:

- A student cannot complete online verification.
- A student cannot complete ID.me verification after following current ID.me help resources.
- A student is under age 18 and parent or guardian involvement may be required.
- The student is in a dual enrollment or special admission pathway.
- Documentation needs additional review.
- The student’s verification status is expired, incomplete, not verified, or unclear.
- The student is requesting financial aid action before verification is complete.
- Staff are unsure which verification pathway applies.
- The situation appears suspicious.
- Staff cannot confirm the authentic student through approved procedures.

Escalation may involve:

- Admissions and Records
- Financial Aid
- Registrar
- Student Services leadership
- Dual Enrollment or Special Admissions contacts
- Information Technology
- Local fraud reporting contact
- Supervisor or designated verification lead



Staff Quick Reference

Student says: "Why do I have to do this?"

Response:

"Identity verification is required before your information can be sent to the college. It helps protect your information and student record."

Student says: "I picked Verify Later. Am I done?"

Response:

"Not yet. Verify Later lets you finish the form first, but you still need to complete verification before your information can be sent to the college."

Student says: "I cannot use DMV Mobile Wallet."

Response:

"You may be able to use ID.me or another approved pathway. If online verification does not work, the college can help you with next steps."

Student says: "My ID.me screen does not match the instructions."

Response:

"ID.me has updated parts of its verification process, so some older screenshots or guides may not match what you see. Please use ID.me's current help resources for the latest instructions. If you still cannot complete verification after that, the college can help you understand your next step."

Student says: "I do not have a smartphone."

Response:

"Please contact the college for support. You may be eligible for an approved local verification process."

Student says: "I am under 18."

Response:

"Students under 18 may have a different verification pathway. Follow the instructions provided in your application, email, text message, or by the college."

Student says: "Does this ask about citizenship?"

Response:

"No. Identity verification confirms identity only. The California Community Colleges do not collect or store citizenship or immigration status through this process."

Student says: "Can you just verify me now?"

Response:



“We need to follow the college’s approved process to confirm we are working with the correct student. I can help direct you to the right next step.”

Key Takeaways for Staff

- Identity verification is required.
- A student’s information cannot be sent to the college until the student is verified or cleared through an approved alternate process.
- Staff play an essential role in helping students understand the process, directing them to the right support, and verifying the authentic student when local verification is needed.
- The goal is to protect students, reduce fraud, and preserve access to California’s community colleges with clarity, consistency, and care.